SFA food classification electric exclusion

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Classification of General Food & Food Products

Different categories of food and food products have to comply with different regulations and requirements, in order for them to be imported, exported, or transhipped.

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Who should use the classification of food and food products?

Food businesses, traders, consumers, and travellers who want to import, export, or tranship food and food products should identify the appropriate classification of their food or food products.

This is an important step, as each category of food and food products has to comply with a specific set of rules for the purposes of importing, exporting, or transhipping.

For example, if a business intends to import frozen pizzas, they have to classify the type of pizza appropriately, depending on the ingredients used. A pizza with meat toppings is classified as Meat & Meat Products, while a pizza with cheese toppings is classified as Processed Food.

What food and food products are listed in the classification?

There are currently 7 categories of food or food products listed in the Classification of Food and Food Products, namely:

Meat

Fish

Fresh fruits and vegetables

Shell eggs and processed eggs

Processed food and food contact articles

Live animals (live poultry & livestock)

Rice

Food-Health Products

Food-health products that are medicinal in nature are regulated by the Health Sciences Authority (HSA).

Food-health products that are non-medicinal in nature and are taken in the form typical of food as part of a daily diet are regulated by SFA. Food-health products that are regulated by SFA include bee pollen, essence of chicken, and herbal jelly.

For more information, see Products in the Food-Health Product Interface.

Live Poultry and Livestock

There are specific requirements and regulations for the import, export and transhipment of live poultry, livestock or live animals. For more information, please see:

What You Need to Know for Import of Live Poultry, Livestock & Live Animal What You Need to Know for Export/Tranship of Live Poultry, Livestock & Live Animal

Overseas establishments exporting live poultry, livestock or live animals must be accredited by SFA. For more information, please refer to Overseas Accreditation of Specific Food & Food Products.

How do I use the classification?

Before importing or exporting any food and food products, check the classification of your food or food products using the table below or the Food & Related Products Classification Tool to determine the likely classification of your food or food products.

Once you have classified your food or food products, please do the following:

Ensure you have a valid SFA registration to import food or food products. If not, please apply for one under Import Processed Food Products and Food Appliances using the GoBusiness portal.

Identify the licence/registration required (and the corresponding supporting documents to be submitted as part of the application for such licence/registration).

Ensure that you are able to comply with the import/export requirements for the category of food or food products. For more information, see Requirements for Licence / Permit / Registration for Import / Export.

Obtain the HS code/product code for your food or food products, which you will need for each consignment you import, export, or tranship.

HS Codes or Product Codes

Before you import, export, or tranship, make sure you understand the nature of your food or food products so that you can choose the correct or most relevant HS/product codes to avoid delays in processing your consignments.

Where can I find the classification?

The classification of food and food products is in the table below along with the HS/Product Codes.

| Classification of Food and Food Products

| Food Group | What is included | HS/Product Codes

| Meat & Meat Products

| Whole carcasses or parts of any animal or bird.

These can be chilled, frozen, processed, or in canned form.

They include products containing meat, animal oil, and fat such as chicken meat powder and lard.

Examples of processed meat products include beef rendang, salami pizza, and bak kwa (BBQ meat slices).

| Please refer to the HS/CA Product Code Checker | Singapore Customs | GoBusiness for the list of HS/product codes.

To retrieve the full list of product codes, click on “Resources” and download from “CA product codes only”.

| Fish & Fish Products

| Any of the following varieties of marine, brackish water, or freshwater:

fishes

crustaceans (e.g. crabs, lobsters, prawns, etc.)

molluscs (e.g. squids, octopus, cuttlefish, etc.)

marine sponges

trepang or marine invertebrates (e.g. sea cucumber)

any other form of aquatic life, including their young and eggs

These can be live, chilled, frozen, processed or in canned form.

| Fresh Fruits & Vegetables

| Raw and unprocessed fruits and vegetables.

Examples include raw (fresh) ginseng and fresh durians.

Excluded: Fruits and vegetables that have undergone some processing such as cutting, peeling, canning, and freezing. These are regulated as processed food.

| Eggs & Egg Products

| Shell eggs

| Processed Eggs

salted and preserved eggs

liquid and powdered eggs

cooked eggs (e.g. hard-boiled eggs and omelette)

| Processed Food & Food Contact Articles

| Processed Food

All food products and supplements of a food nature that are not grouped as meat products, fish products, or fresh fruits and fresh vegetables.

Examples include:

mineral water

wine

infant formula

milk and milk products such as cheese, milk powder, and yoghurt

biscuits

cooking oil

beverages

nuts

insects and insect products

| Food Contact Articles

Any item that is meant to come into contact with food and beverages and does not require electricity* to function.

Food ware such as:

bowls

cups

plates

pans

pots

water bottles

Food utensils such as:

chopsticks

spoons

Appliances that require electricity are not regulated by SFA. You may want to use the Singapore Customs HS/CA Product Code search tool instead.

| Live animals (live poultry & livestock)

| Live poultry, livestock and animal are domestic birds and animals meant for the purpose of slaughter for consumption.

Examples include live chickens and live pigs.

| Rice

| Raw rice | Product codes for Raw Rice

Frequently Asked Questions

What are some common mistakes made by importers, exporters or transhippers when classifying their products?

The most common mistake is the incorrect classification of their food or food products.

You must review and assess the ingredients in your food or food product to determine the correct classification. For example, you should not assume that all canned food is to be classified as ‘Processed Food’. A can of beef rendang is classified as ‘Meat and Meat Products’, and the relevant requirements and regulations would apply.

Another common mistake is the incorrect classification of products that contain a small amount of meat or animal fat/oil. Products that contain a small amount of meat or animal fat/oil (e.g. instant noodles that contain chicken oil) must be assessed and approved by SFA. You should submit all the following information with supporting documents to SFA via the Online Feedback Form:

country of origin of final product

country of origin of raw meat and/or animal fat used

processing flow chart including the heat treatment process (i.e. heat temperature and duration)

composition of ingredients (with percentage of meat/animal fat in the final product)

importer details (UEN and SFA licence number)

Who can I turn to for help if I am uncertain how to classify my food or food products?

You can use our Food & Related Products Classification Tool to determine the likely classification of your food or food products.

For more information You can contact us via the SFA Online Feedback Form.

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Products in the Food-Health Product Interface

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